

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥8

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥J

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥2

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣5

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠K

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 6 5
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ 10
♣ A 10 6 5

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ K 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 3 2

♥ A 8 4

♦ 9 8 7 4 3

♣ 9 4

♠ A 10 8

♥ K J 3

♦ A J 5

♣ Q J 7 2

West

Pass

North

1NT

East

Pass

South

4NT

All Pass

4NT by North

Lead: ♥8

NORTH has a low-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

SOUTH has 16 points; he figures the partnership holds either 31, 32 or 33. Obviously he wants to at least reach game, but if NORTH holds 17 points he wants to reach slam.

SOUTH bids 4NT. Since this is more than game it should be clear to NORTH that he is asking her to bid 6NT if she is at the top of her range. It is clear to NORTH, but with just 15 points she passes.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 8 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ K J 3
♣ K 10 5 2

♠ J 9 7 6

♥ A 4

♦ A 9 5 4 2

♣ 8 4



♠ A Q 5

♥ K 8 5

♦ Q 10 7 6

♣ A 9 7

♠ K 3 2

♥ J 10 9 3 2

♦ 8

♣ Q J 6 3

EAST has a minimum 1NT opening hand - balanced distribution with 15 points.

WEST has 9 points, which is not enough to bid game, but is worth making an invitational bid. So she says 2NT.

Since EAST is minimum he declines the invitation by passing.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

Lead: ♥J

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 6 3

♥ J 8 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ 9 7 6

♠ K 10 5

♥ Q 6 3

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ A K 3



♠ 9 7 2

♥ 10 9 7 5

♦ J 10 9 3

♣ 8 4

♠ Q J 4

♥ A K

♦ K 7 6

♣ Q J 10 5 2

SOUTH has 17 points, counting 1 for the fifth Club.
She has a balanced distribution so she opens 1NT.

NORTH is also balanced, so he does the math.

SOUTH has either 15, 16 or 17, and with NORTH's 18 the partnership total is either 33, 34 or 35. That is enough for a small slam, but below the 37 points needed for Grand Slam so he bids 6NT.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Lead: ♥2

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 9
♥ A K 8
♦ A Q 5 3
♣ K Q 8

♠ A 6 5 3

♥ 10 4 2

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ 5 2



♠ K 7 4

♥ Q J 5

♦ K J 10

♣ A 7 4 3

♠ 10 8 2

♥ 9 7 6 3

♦ 7 6

♣ J 10 9 6

West

2NT

All Pass

6NT by West

Lead: ♣5

North

Pass

East

6NT

South

The partner who is first sure what the final contract should be should just go ahead and bid it. This is called "She who knows, goes."

In this deal, for example, it is EAST who knows. She has a balanced 14 points, so when WEST indicates 20/21 points with his opening 2NT bid she KNOWS the partnership holds about 34/35 points.

Therefore she GOES to 6NT.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 2
♥ 10 8 7 2
♦ 2
♣ A Q 10 4 2

♠ A 10 6
♥ A Q 4
♦ K Q J 10
♣ K J 7



♠ K Q J 4
♥ J 5 3
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ 8 3

♠ 8 5 3
♥ K 9 6
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ 9 6 5

NORTH has a balanced 20 point hand - ideal to open 2NT.

SOUTH has 7 points; he knows the partnership has either 27 or 28 points so he bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠K			